

signs, obstacles and lanes among other things to determine the relative position of the vehicle they're attached to. These inputs also calculate the speed of the vehicle in relation to all the other variables listed to maintain a safe distance or compensate for changes, applying emergency brakes if needed or even prompt steering to keep within lanes.

Does this mean, a car with ADAS can drive itself?

ADAS is divided into six levels of automation that varies from only warnings to partial autonomous control and to the highest level that allows fully autonomous operation of the vehicle. Basic assistance features like parking sensors, surround-view cameras, traffic sign recognition, lane departure warning, rear-cross traffic alert, forward-collision warning and any other feature that bases the final decision of action on the driver is classified as Level 0. In short, any warning system that alerts a driver of a possible object, obstruction and errors such as veering away from a lane is the basic level of an ADAS.

SAFE DRIVING
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Level 1 and 2 take over some functions like emergency braking when warnings are ignored, steering correction if lane departure is detected and similar features. The system still uses Level 0 warnings, relying first on human decision-making, but is programmed to assist with intervention. The difference between Level 1 and Level 2 is that the former can only take over one function while the latter can control multiple functions. Adaptive Cruise Control would be an example of Level 1 autonomy while autonomous parking would be classified as Level 2 autonomy. The current crop of cars available in India offer Level 0 to Level 2 ADAS features. These features don't vary according to price as has become clear on testing various cars, such as the Mercedes-AMG E 63 S with just basic warnings, the new Skoda Slavia with multi-collision braking assistance and the Mahindra XUV that offers up to Level 2 automation of ADAS functions. At present, these systems aren't mandated by law or standardised, but

